

GRIDALIGN

Coordination Opportunity Report

Georgia Power

Effingham County 500 kV

Distance between closest known points: 39.56 km

Dominion Energy South Carolina

Okatie - McIntosh 115kV Tie: Add Series Reactor

PROJECTS

- Project A: Effingham County 500 kV, located in Effingham County, Georgia. The operating company is not specified in the supplied data.
- Project B: Okatie - McIntosh 115kV Tie: Add Series Reactor, located in Beaufort County, South Carolina. The operating company is not specified in the supplied data.

WHY GRIDALIGN FLAGGED THIS PAIR

The closest known points between these two projects are 39.56 km apart. This places the pair within GridAlign's under 40 km screening category.

GEOGRAPHIC ANALYSIS

At 39.56 km apart, these projects are separated across the Georgia and South Carolina state line. This distance is too great to support daily operational integration, shared access roads, or joint laydown yards. However, under the 40 km threshold, the projects may still be close enough to allow for regional construction planning, shared mobilization of specialized contractors, or regional crew allocation.

TIMELINE ANALYSIS

Project A has a planned start date of Fall 2027, with no completion date provided. Project B lists a completion date of 12/31/2028, but its start date is missing. Because schedule information for both projects is incomplete, timeline compatibility cannot be fully confirmed. If Project B undergoes construction during late 2027 or 2028, a window of concurrent activity could potentially occur.

COORDINATION OPPORTUNITIES

- Regional contractor sharing: The utilities could potentially engage the same specialized electrical or substation contractors for work across both sites.
- Equipment mobilization: If specialized heavy equipment or high-voltage testing apparatus is required, transport could potentially be coordinated sequentially between the two projects.

- Regional outage planning: Transmission system operators may be able to coordinate outage schedules to prevent simultaneous system stress in adjacent utility territories.

POTENTIAL BENEFITS

- Potential cost efficiencies from sharing regional contractor mobilization or demobilization expenses.
- Enhanced grid reliability by coordinating outage windows between the 500 kV transmission additions and the 115 kV switching station work.

RISKS AND LIMITATIONS

- Incomplete schedule data makes it impossible to verify whether construction activities will actually coincide.
- The projects are situated in different states, which may involve separate regulatory authorities, operating utilities, and permitting processes.
- The 39.56 km separation sits at the outer boundary of the coordination threshold, precluding direct site logistics sharing.
- The scopes differ substantially in voltage level and scale, ranging from a major 500 kV transmission project to a localized 115 kV switching station and series reactor installation.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

LOW

While the projects fall just inside the 40 km regional radius, the substantial physical distance, cross-border jurisdictions, differing voltage scopes, and unconfirmed schedule overlap mean only limited or indirect regional coordination appears useful.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Project planners should conduct an initial inter-utility scheduling call to establish firm construction dates and evaluate whether joint regional outage sequencing is warranted.